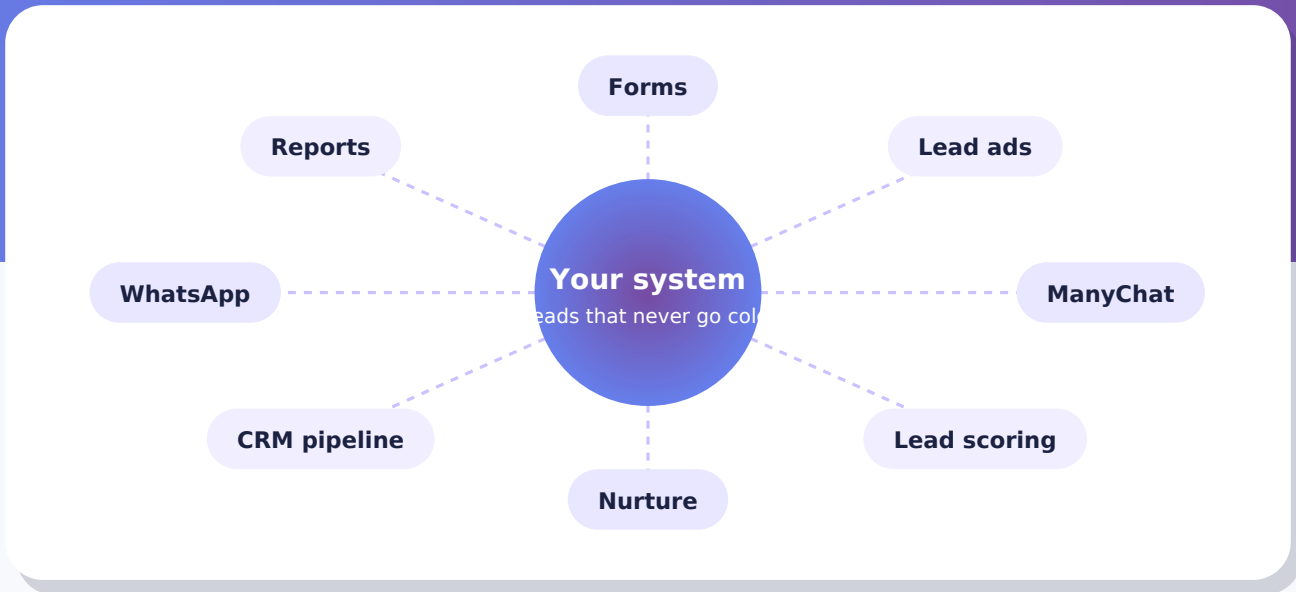
WEEK 15 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

Marketing Automation

Lead capture, scoring, nurturing and CRM workflows for businesses in Mauritius, step by step

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PART A

Foundations

What marketing automation is,
the lead lifecycle and the
building blocks of every workflow

SECTION 1

What marketing automation is (and is not)

Marketing automation means using software to capture, organise and follow up leads and customers automatically, based on rules you decide. The system does the repetitive work (saving a contact, sending the next email, alerting a salesperson, updating a stage) so that people can spend their time on real conversations.

Where this week fits

In **Week 10** you built an email list, wrote a welcome series, set up simple automations in Mailchimp and created a HubSpot free CRM. In **Week 14** you used AI inside automations to write, summarise and classify. This week joins everything together into an **automation system**: leads arrive from forms, ads and messaging apps, land in one CRM, are scored, nurtured stage by stage and handed to sales at the right moment, with every step measured.

	Week 10: email automation	Week 15: marketing automation system
Scope	One channel (email), one tool	Many channels and tools connected: forms, lead ads, DMs, WhatsApp, email, CRM, sales
Typical flow	Signs up → 5 welcome emails	Lead ad → CRM → score → branch by profile → nurture → sales task → deal → onboarding
Decision rules	Mostly time-based (day 2, day 5)	Behaviour-based (clicked, visited, replied) plus profile (fit)
Who is involved	Marketing	Marketing and sales together, with agreed rules
Main result	Opens, clicks, first purchase	Leads converted, time to convert, revenue influenced

What automation does for a business

- **No lead is forgotten.** Every enquiry is saved, gets an owner and a next step, even at 23:00 on a Sunday.
- **Speed.** The brochure, the price list or the booking link arrives in seconds, while interest is high.
- **Relevance.** A company HR manager and a student asking about the same course receive different follow-ups.
- **Focus for sales.** Salespeople call the leads most likely to buy, not the ones who shouted loudest.
- **Consistency.** Every customer gets the same good experience, whoever is on duty.
- **Measurement.** You can see where leads come from, where they get stuck and what they are worth.

Myths and realities

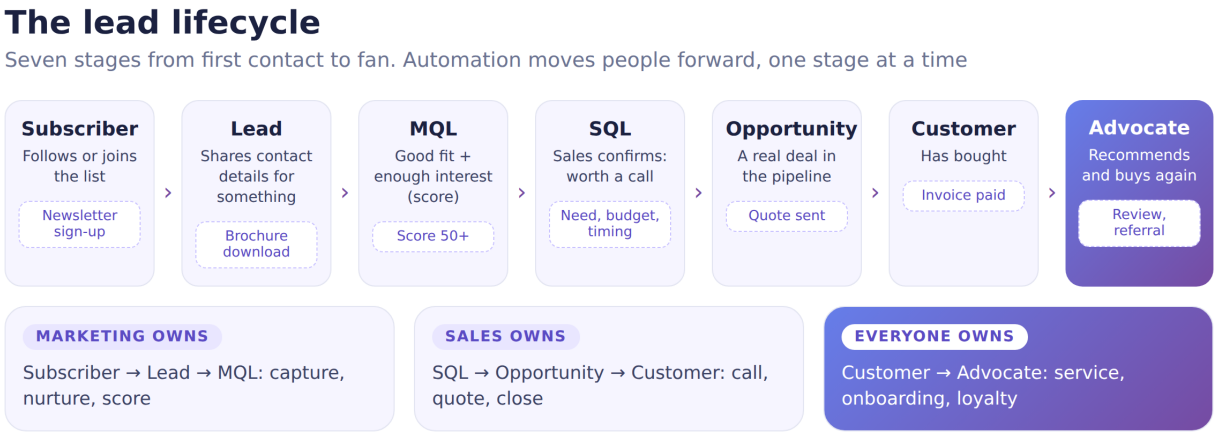
Myth	Reality
"Automation replaces people."	It removes repetitive tasks. People still build relationships, answer complex questions and close sales.
"It is only for big companies."	A gym or a training centre with two staff gains the most, because they have no time to chase every lead by hand.
"Set it and forget it."	Prices, links, offers and teams change. Every automation needs an owner and a regular check (Section 26).
"More messages means more sales."	Badly targeted automation annoys people, gets you blocked on WhatsApp and sends email to spam.
"The tool is the strategy."	The tool only follows your rules. Bad rules automated = bad results, faster.

> **The golden rule:** automate a process that already works by hand. If you cannot explain on paper what should happen to a new lead, no tool can do it for you.

SECTION 2

The lead lifecycle: from subscriber to advocate

The lead lifecycle describes where a person is in their relationship with your business. Each stage has a clear entry rule, an owner and a goal. Automation exists to move people from one stage to the next, at their own pace.



The stages explained

Stage	Definition	Typical entry rule (example)	Owner
Subscriber	Agreed to receive content, nothing more	Newsletter sign-up, follows a WhatsApp Channel	Marketing
Lead	Shared contact details in exchange for something specific	Downloaded a brochure, filled a lead ad, sent a DM with a phone number	Marketing
MQL (Marketing Qualified Lead)	Good fit and enough interest for sales to contact	Lead score of 50 or more (Section 10)	Marketing → sales
SQL (Sales Qualified Lead)	Sales has spoken to them and confirmed a real need	Discovery call done: need, budget, timing confirmed	Sales
Opportunity	A specific deal with a value in the pipeline	Quote or proposal requested or sent	Sales
Customer	Has bought	Deal won, invoice paid	Sales → service
Advocate (HubSpot: Evangelist)	Recommends you, reviews, refers, buys again	Left a review, referred someone, second purchase	Everyone

Rules that keep the lifecycle useful

1. **Write down the entry rule for each stage**, so that marketing and sales mean the same thing by "MQL".
2. **Stages normally only move forward.** A customer who stops buying is still a customer; use a separate property such as "Status: lapsed" rather than moving them back to "Lead".
3. **A lead can skip stages.** Someone who asks for a quote on day one is a hand-raiser: send them straight to sales.
4. **Record the date** each stage was reached. That is how you measure time to convert (Section 24).
5. **Keep a "Disqualified" or "Other" reason** (student, competitor, wrong country, no budget) so these contacts leave the nurture flows.

Lifecycle stage vs deal stage (reminder from Week 10)

Lifecycle stage describes the **person** (where they are with your business). Deal stage describes **one sale** in the pipeline. One company that sends staff on training three times a year has one lifecycle stage (Customer) and three deals.

> **In Mauritius:** in a small market, the same person often comes back years later (a second car, a new course, another event). Never delete customers from the CRM just because they have not bought recently; keep their history and consent status, and let a win-back or "new need" trigger bring them back into a flow.

SECTION 3

The building blocks of every automation

Whatever the tool, every automation is made of the same five pieces. Once you know them, you can read a Zapier Zap, a Make scenario, a HubSpot workflow, a Mailchimp flow or a ManyChat automation.

The five building blocks of every automation

Zapier, Make, HubSpot, Mailchimp and ManyChat use different names for the same ideas



The same idea, different names

Idea	Zapier	Make	HubSpot	Mailchimp	ManyChat
The automation	Zap	Scenario	Workflow	Flow	Automation
Starting event	Trigger	Trigger module (instant or scheduled)	Enrolment trigger	Starting point / trigger	Trigger (keyword, comment, story reply…)
A step	Action	Module	Action	Action	Step / message
Split into paths	Paths	Router	If/then branch	If/else	Condition
Stop or continue	Filter	Filter (on a route)	Branch / unenrol rule	Condition	Condition
Wait	Delay	Sleep or scheduling	Delay	Time delay	Smart delay
What you pay for	Tasks	Credits (formerly operations)	Subscription tier	Contacts and sends	Active contacts

Triggers: what can start an automation

Trigger type	Examples
Form or data entry	Website form, lead ad, ManyChat collects an email, new row in a Google Sheet
Behaviour	Clicked a link, visited the pricing page twice, opened a chat, watched a webinar
Change of data	Lifecycle stage changed to MQL, deal moved to "Quote sent", tag added
Date	Birthday, renewal date, 3 days before an event, 12 months after a car purchase
Inactivity	No email click for 90 days, no reply to a quote for 7 days
Message	Keyword in a DM ("PRICE"), a comment on a post, a reply to a WhatsApp message

Instant vs scheduled triggers

Some triggers fire instantly (a webhook: the app sends the data the moment something happens). Others are checked on a schedule ("polling"): on free plans, Zapier and Make check every 15 minutes. For a hot lead, those 15 minutes can matter, so use instant triggers where the app offers them.

Goals and exit criteria

A **goal** is the outcome that ends the flow because it worked (booked a call, bought). An **exit criterion** removes people for other reasons (unsubscribed, became a customer through another route, disqualified). Without them, a customer who already paid keeps receiving "Don’t miss out!" emails, which looks careless.

SECTION 4

Automation in Mauritius: what is different

The principles are global, but the way Mauritians enquire and buy shapes what you automate. Design for how your customers really behave, not for a template from abroad.

Local reality	What it means for your automation
Conversations end on WhatsApp	Make WhatsApp a planned step in the flow (reminder, follow-up, handover), and log WhatsApp leads in the CRM like any other lead.
Several languages	Store a "Preferred language" property (English, French, Kreol) and branch messages by language. Keep Kreol for informal channels if that suits your brand.
Small teams	Two or three people often do marketing, sales and service. Automate alerts and tasks so nobody depends on memory.
Phone numbers as the main ID	Many leads give a phone number, not an email. Store numbers in one format (+230 5XXX XXXX) so tools can match and deduplicate (Section 22).
Strong word of mouth	Referrals and reviews matter a lot in a small island. Build the "advocate" stage into your system.
Mixed online and offline	Leads come from walk-ins, fairs and phone calls too. Use a simple mobile form or a shared sheet so staff can enter them, then let automation take over.

Local reality	What it means for your automation
Tourism and diaspora audiences	Hotels and tour operators deal with foreign guests: time zones, other languages and the EU GDPR (Section 25).

Typical automation opportunities by sector

Sector	High-value automations
Training and education	Brochure → nurture → information session reminder → enrolment → onboarding → certificate → alumni referral
Car dealers and rental	Lead ad or website enquiry → test-drive booking → reminders → follow-up after visit → financing documents → service reminders
Gyms and wellness	Instagram DM → free trial booking → reminders → post-trial offer → onboarding → renewal and win-back
Hotels and guesthouses	Direct-booking enquiry → offer → pre-arrival → in-stay WhatsApp → review request → anniversary offer
B2B services	Content download → scoring → discovery call → proposal follow-up → client onboarding → quarterly check-ins
Retail and e-commerce	Welcome → abandoned cart → post-purchase → replenishment reminder → VIP and win-back

Tip: start by listing every place where a lead currently waits for a human to remember something ("I will send the brochure tonight", "I must call back Mr Ramsamy"). Each of those is an automation waiting to be built.

PART B

Strategy & lead capture

Journey mapping, priorities,
lead capture on every channel
and lead scoring

SECTION 5

Map the journey before you automate

An automation system starts on paper (or a whiteboard), not in a tool. You map how a person goes from first contact to customer, then mark the moments where automation can help.

Step by step: the automation journey map

1. **Pick one offer and one audience**, for example "corporate Excel training for HR managers" or "test drive of a new SUV".
2. **List every entry point**: website form, lead ad, Instagram DM, WhatsApp, phone call, walk-in, event.
3. **Write the stages** the person goes through (Section 2) and the question they have at each stage ("Is this for me?", "How much?", "Can I trust them?", "When can I start?").
4. **Write what happens today** at each step, and who does it. Be honest: "Brochure sent when someone remembers."
5. **Mark the gaps**: where leads wait, get lost, or receive the wrong message.
6. **Decide the automation** for each gap: trigger, action, delay, condition, goal.
7. **Decide the human moments**: where a person must call, meet or decide. Automation prepares these moments; it does not replace them.

Example: journey map for a training company (extract)

Stage	Their question	Today	Automated tomorrow
Lead	"What is in the course and how much?"	Brochure emailed manually, sometimes days later	Brochure email sent instantly; contact created in CRM with source
Lead	"Is it worth it?"	Nothing	3 nurture emails over 9 days: outcomes, testimonials, FAQ
MQL	"Can my team do it in-house?"	Nothing unless they call	Score 50+ → task for sales: call within 1 working day
Opportunity	"Let me think about it"	Quote sent, no follow-up	Reminder task on day 3; email with case study on day 5
Customer	"What do I need on day one?"	Phone calls the day before	Joining instructions, map and WhatsApp reminder automatically
Advocate	"Who else would benefit?"	Nothing	Certificate email + referral offer + review request

> **Tip:** use sticky notes or a free whiteboard such as Miro, FigJam or Google Drawings. Map first, then build. Changing a sticky note takes seconds; rebuilding a broken workflow takes hours.

SECTION 6

Choosing what to automate first

You cannot automate everything at once, and you should not. Start with the automations that save the most time or rescue the most revenue, with the least effort.

The impact and effort test

	Low effort	High effort
High impact	**Do first**: instant lead capture to CRM, new-lead alert to sales, brochure auto-reply, appointment reminders	**Plan next**: lead scoring, multi-branch nurture, CRM–WhatsApp integration
Low impact	**Quick wins if time**: birthday emails, internal reports by email	**Avoid for now**: complex AI chatbots, 20-step flows nobody maintains

The first five automations for almost any business

1. **Lead capture to CRM:** every form, lead ad and DM lead creates or updates a contact, with source and consent.
2. **Instant response:** the person receives what they asked for (brochure, prices, booking link) within a minute.
3. **New-lead alert and task:** the right person is notified and a follow-up task with a due date is created.
4. **Reminders:** appointments, test drives, trial classes and information sessions get reminders (email and WhatsApp) to reduce no-shows.
5. **Follow-up after no response:** if a quote or a lead gets no reply after X days, a reminder goes out and the salesperson gets a task.

> **Rule of thumb:** build one automation, test it, run it for two weeks, check the results, then build the next one. A small system that works beats a big one that breaks.

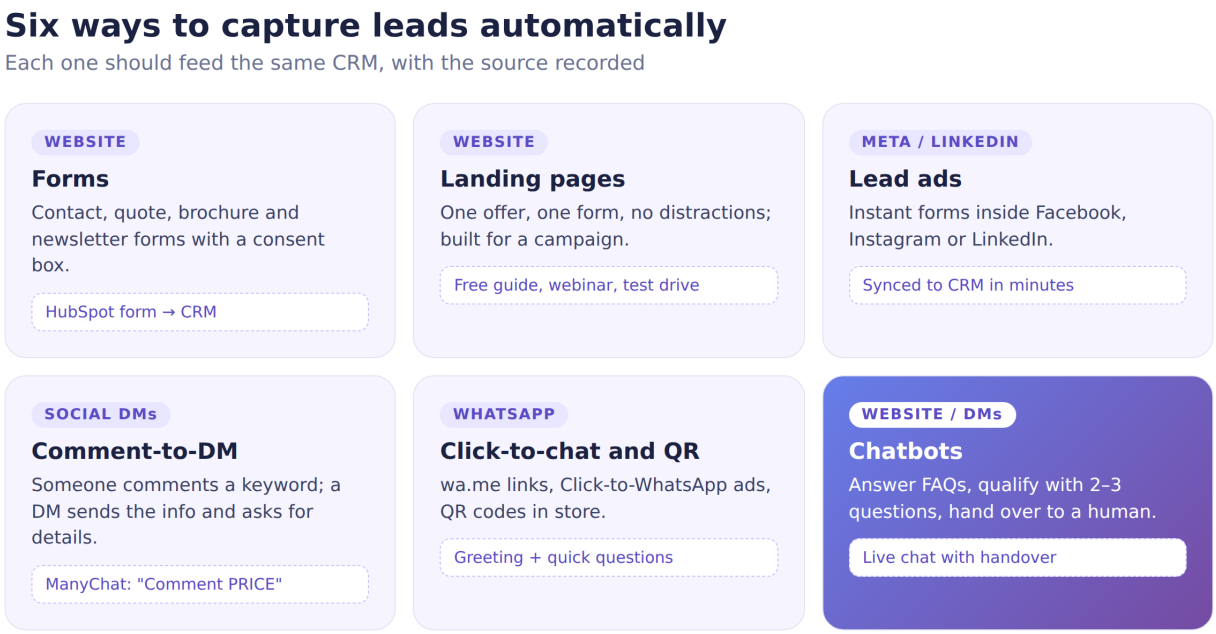
Questions to ask before building any automation

- ☐ What exact problem does it solve, and how will I know it worked?
- ☐ Who receives it, and did they agree to receive it (consent)?
- ☐ What happens if the data is missing or wrong (no first name, no email)?
- ☐ When does a person leave this flow?
- ☐ Who owns it and checks it every month?

SECTION 7

Lead capture 1: forms and landing pages

Forms are the front door of your automation system. A good form collects the right information, records consent, tells the system where the lead came from and starts the right workflow.



Designing a form that feeds automation

Element	Good practice	Why it matters for automation
Fields	Only what you need now: first name, email or phone, 1–2 qualifying questions	Fewer fields = more leads; qualifying fields feed the fit score
Dropdowns, not free text	"Company size: 1–9 / 10–49 / 50–249 / 250+"	Clean values can drive branches and scores
Phone field	Country code pre-set to +230; one format	Matching and WhatsApp follow-up work reliably
Consent checkbox	Unticked; separate for marketing email and WhatsApp	Proof of consent saved to the contact (Section 25)
Hidden fields	UTM source, medium, campaign; page URL	Every lead knows where it came from (Week 2)
Thank-you page	Says what happens next and when	Can fire a GA4 key event and an ad conversion
Spam protection	reCAPTCHA or a hidden "honeypot" field	Keeps fake leads out of your flows

Landing pages that convert

- **One page, one offer, one action.** No menu that takes people elsewhere.
- **A headline that matches the ad or post** people clicked ("Free guide: 10 Excel formulas every HR manager needs").

- **Benefits, proof and a short form** above the fold on a phone.
- **A clear lead magnet** (guide, checklist, price list, webinar, free trial, test drive) worth exchanging contact details for (Week 10).
- **Tracking:** GA4 key event on the thank-you page, Meta Pixel and Google tag where you advertise (Week 2, Weeks 6–8).

Tools for forms and landing pages

Tool	Good for
HubSpot free forms and landing pages	Leads go straight into the CRM with source; one simple follow-up email per form on free tools
Mailchimp forms and landing pages	Newsletter and lead magnet sign-ups into an audience with tags
Website form plugins (WordPress, Wix, Shopify)	Forms on your own site; connect to the CRM natively or via Zapier/Make
Google Forms and Typeform	Quick surveys, event registrations, internal entry of offline leads
Meta and LinkedIn lead ads	Forms inside the platform, pre-filled from the profile (Section 8)

In Mauritius: add a field "How would you like us to contact you?" (WhatsApp, phone call, email). Many Mauritian customers prefer WhatsApp, and respecting that choice in your workflow increases response rates.

SECTION 8

Lead capture 2: lead ads, DMs, WhatsApp and chatbots

A growing share of leads never visits your website. They answer a lead ad, comment on a Reel or send a WhatsApp message. Your system must capture these leads as reliably as a website form.

Lead ads (Meta and LinkedIn)

Lead ads with instant forms (Week 8) collect details inside Facebook or Instagram, pre-filled from the person’s profile. The weak point is what happens next: many businesses download a spreadsheet once a week, by which time the lead has forgotten them.

- **Connect lead ads to your CRM.** HubSpot’s ads tool, available on all plans including the free tools, can sync Facebook lead ad submissions into contacts once you connect the ad account and enable syncing for the Page; leads from the last 90 days are imported when you connect.
- **Or use Zapier or Make** ("Facebook Lead Ads" trigger) to send each lead to Google Sheets, Mailchimp, HubSpot or a WhatsApp alert within minutes.
- **Do not rely on manual downloads.** Meta keeps lead data available for a limited period only (90 days, according to tool providers), and slow follow-up wastes your ad budget.
- **Add a qualifying question** to the form ("When do you plan to buy?") and a custom disclaimer with your consent wording.

Comment-to-DM and keyword automation with ManyChat

ManyChat connects to Instagram, Facebook Messenger, TikTok, Telegram and, on paid plans, WhatsApp, SMS and email. A classic flow: you post a Reel saying "Comment GUIDE and I’ll send you the checklist". When someone comments the keyword, ManyChat replies publicly, sends a DM with the checklist, asks for an email or phone number, tags the contact and sends the data to your CRM or a Google Sheet.

ManyChat plan (October 2026)	Price	Active contacts / month	Channels
Free	USD 0	25	2 of Instagram, TikTok, Messenger, Telegram; up to 4 live automations; "Powered by Manychat" branding
Essential	USD 14 / month	250	Same 2 channels; unlimited automations, tags, scheduled messages
Pro	USD 29 / month	2,500	3 channels from Instagram, TikTok, Messenger, WhatsApp, Telegram, SMS, email; broadcasts and AI features
Business	USD 69 / month	7,500	All channels, 5 users, automation insights

Prices from manychat.com/pricing, monthly billing, checked October 2026. Extra active contacts are charged above each limit. Check the current page before you buy.

Messaging windows: the rules that limit automation

- **Instagram and Messenger:** a 24-hour window opens after the person’s last message or interaction. Inside it, automated messages are allowed. After that, a 7-day window allows manual replies only; promotional automated messages outside the window break Meta’s policy.
- **WhatsApp (Business Platform):** 24-hour customer service window; outside it you must use an approved message template (Section 18).
- **Practical consequence:** collect an email address or WhatsApp opt-in during the conversation, so you can continue nurturing after the window closes.

Chatbots: qualify, then hand over

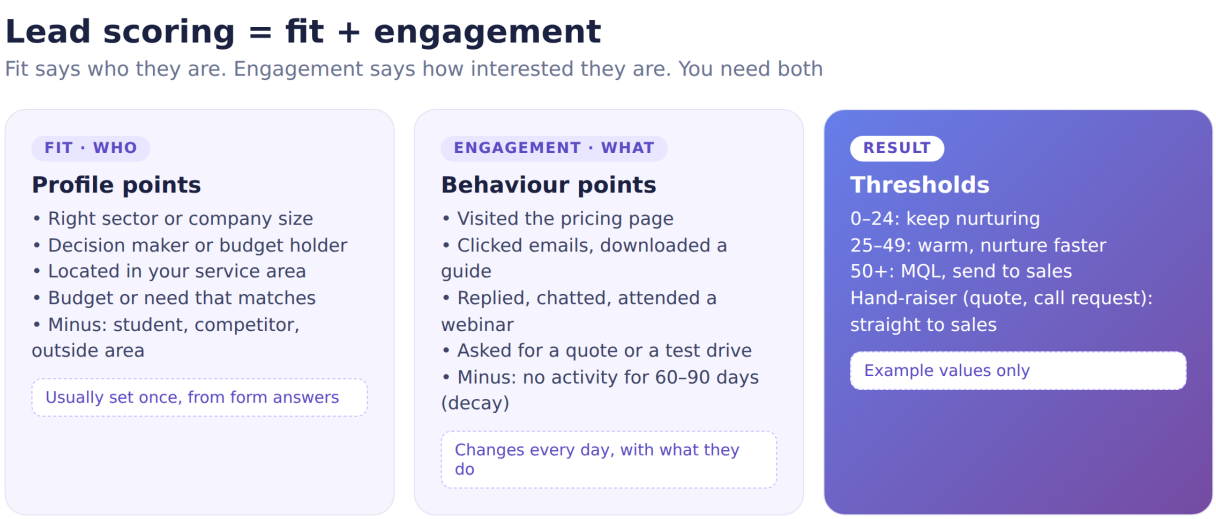
A website or Messenger chatbot (HubSpot’s free chatbot builder, ManyChat, or an AI assistant from Week 14) can answer frequent questions and ask 2–3 qualifying questions: what are you interested in, for when, how should we contact you. Always offer "Talk to a person", and tell people when they are talking to a bot.

> Keyword automations must deliver what they promise, instantly. If someone comments "PRICE" and receives nothing, or a generic "Thanks for your comment", you lose the lead and look unprofessional in public.

SECTION 9

Lead scoring: how it works

Lead scoring gives each lead a number that estimates how ready and how suitable they are to buy. Week 10 introduced the idea; this week you build a real model and connect it to your workflows.



The two dimensions

	Fit (explicit) score	Engagement (implicit) score
Measures	How well the lead matches your ideal customer	How interested the lead is right now
Data from	Form answers, CRM properties, company data	Email clicks, page visits, chats, downloads, events, replies
Changes	Rarely	Constantly; should decay over time
Question it answers	"Should we sell to them?"	"Should we call them now?"

Reading fit and engagement together

	High engagement	Low engagement
High fit	**Call now** (MQL → sales)	**Nurture** with education and proof; good future customer
Low fit	**Check**: a student or a small budget? Offer a self-service option	**Light touch**: newsletter only

HubSpot’s lead scoring tool uses the same logic: separate fit and engagement scores, a combined score, and labels from A1 (high fit, high engagement) to C3 (low fit, low engagement). Automatic scoring in HubSpot requires Marketing Hub or Sales Hub Professional or Enterprise. On free tools you calculate the score in a spreadsheet or a number property (Section 10).

Hand-raisers skip the queue

Some actions are so strong that the score does not matter: asking for a quote, booking a call, requesting a test drive, replying "I’m interested". Treat these as **hand-raisers** and route them to sales immediately, whatever the score.

SECTION 10

Build your lead scoring model, step by step

A good first model has 6–12 rules, a clear threshold and a monthly review. Start simple, then let real results tell you what to change.

Step by step

1. **Look at your last 20–50 customers.** What do they have in common (sector, size, job, area, budget)? Which actions did they take before buying?
2. **Agree the ideal customer profile** with sales and write the fit criteria with points.
3. **List engagement actions** and give bigger points to actions closer to buying (pricing page, quote) than to light actions (email open).
4. **Add negative points** for poor fit (student email, competitor, outside service area) and for inactivity.
5. **Add decay:** engagement points lose value over time, for example engagement older than 90 days no longer counts.
6. **Set thresholds and caps**: e.g. 50 = MQL; cap engagement at 60 so that someone who opens every newsletter cannot become an MQL without fit.
7. **Test on past leads:** score 20 old leads; do the ones who bought score highest? Adjust.
8. **Connect it to action:** reaching the threshold changes the lifecycle stage, creates a sales task and moves the lead into the MQL flow.
9. **Review monthly** with sales: what share of MQLs became SQLs? Too low → raise the threshold or change the points.

Example 1: B2B training company in Ebène (illustrative)

"SkillPort Training" (fictional) sells Excel, leadership and digital marketing courses to companies. Its ideal customer: HR or training managers in companies with 20+ employees in Mauritius.

Type	Rule	Points
Fit	Job title contains HR, training, L&D, people, or manager/director	+15
Fit	Company size 20–249 / 250+	+10 / +15
Fit	Based in Mauritius	+5
Fit	Personal email (gmail, yahoo) for a corporate enquiry	−5
Fit	Student or job seeker (form answer)	−20 (route to public courses)
Engagement	Downloaded the corporate brochure	+10
Engagement	Clicked a nurture email (each, max 3)	+3
Engagement	Visited the "In-house training" or pricing page	+10
Engagement	Attended the free webinar	+15
Engagement	No activity for 60 days	−10
Hand-raiser	Requested a quote or booked a call	Straight to sales

Threshold: 50 points = MQL. Example: an HR manager (+15) at a 120-person company (+10) in Mauritius (+5) downloads the brochure (+10) and visits the in-house page (+10) = 50 → MQL + sales task.

Example 2: car dealer in Phoenix (illustrative)

"AutoVert Motors" (fictional) sells new and used cars. Leads come from Facebook lead ads, the website and Click-to-WhatsApp ads. Here, timing and financing matter more than job title.

Type	Rule	Points
Fit	Purchase timeframe: within 1 month / 1–3 months / just looking	+20 / +10 / 0
Fit	Budget range matches the model enquired about	+10
Fit	Has a car to trade in	+5
Fit	Financing pre-check started	+10
Engagement	Viewed 3+ vehicle pages in 7 days	+10
Engagement	Opened the price list or brochure on WhatsApp	+5
Engagement	Used the loan calculator	+10
Engagement	No reply or visit for 30 days	−15
Hand-raiser	Booked a test drive or asked for a trade-in valuation	Straight to sales

Threshold: 40 points = hot lead → salesperson calls the same day. Worked example: buying within 1 month (+20), budget matches (+10), used the loan calculator (+10) = 40 → hot lead.

Where to keep the score without paid software

- **Google Sheets:** one row per lead, columns for each rule, a SUM formula and conditional formatting (green at 50+). Zapier or Make adds new leads as rows.
- **HubSpot free:** create a custom number property "Manual score" and update it (by hand, by import or through an integration). Use a saved view "Score 50+, no owner" each morning.
- **ManyChat or Mailchimp tags:** tags such as "hot-timeframe" or "downloaded-brochure" can be counted in your sheet or CRM.

> Do not over-engineer. A model with 30 rules that nobody understands is worse than six rules sales trusts. The score is a conversation starter, not a verdict.

PART C

Build the system

Nurture sequences, triggers, workflow design, Zapier, Make, ManyChat and WhatsApp

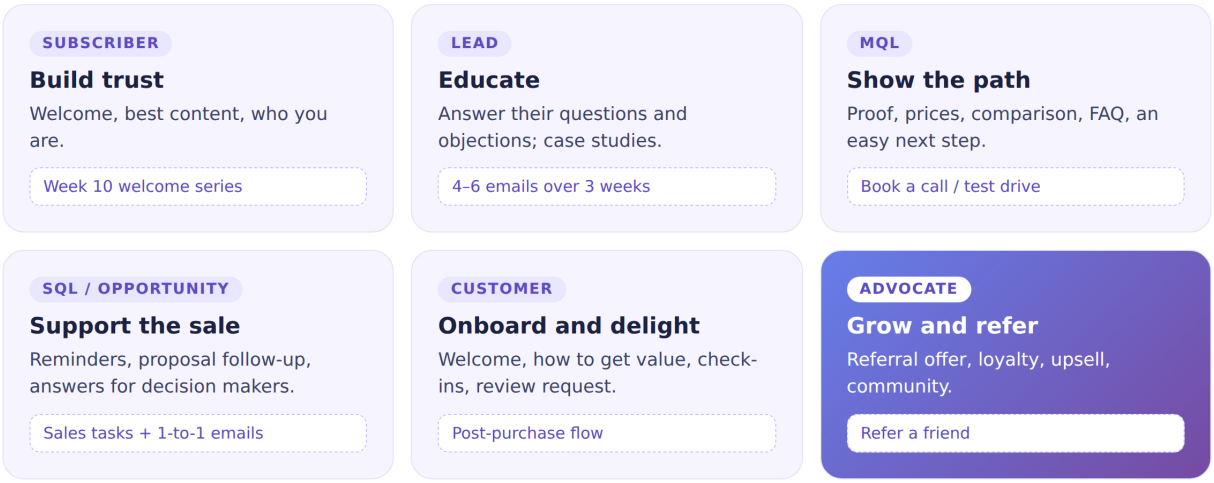
SECTION 11

Nurture sequences by stage

Lead nurturing means building a relationship with leads who are not ready to buy yet, by sending useful, relevant messages until they are. The secret is to match the message to the stage.

Nurture by stage: the right message at the right time

Each stage has one job. Content that is perfect for one stage is wrong for another



What to send at each stage

Stage	Goal	Content that works	Typical length and rhythm	Exit when
Subscriber	Trust	Welcome series, best content, story (Week 10)	3–5 emails over 2 weeks, then newsletter	Becomes a lead (downloads, asks)
Lead	Education	Answers to their top 5 questions, guides, case studies, short videos	4–6 messages over 3–4 weeks	Reaches MQL or raises a hand
MQL	Move to a c onversation	Proof, prices or price ranges, comparisons, FAQ, "book a call"	2–3 messages over 10 days + sales task	Sales accepts (SQL) or recycles
SQL / opportunity	Support the decision	Proposal follow-up, answers for other decision makers, references	Driven by sales tasks; 1-to-1 emails	Won or lost
Customer	Value and retention	Onboarding, tips, check-ins, review request	3–5 messages over the first 30–60 days	Onboarding complete
Advocate	Referrals and repeat	Referral offer, loyalty news, upgrades, events	Occasional, triggered by milestones	Unsubscribes or new deal

Writing a lead nurture sequence: example

SkillPort Training, corporate track (illustrative). Trigger: corporate brochure downloaded. Exit: books a call, requests a quote, or unsubscribes.

#	Timing	Channel	Message	Call to action
1	Immediately	Email	Your brochure + "3 questions to ask before choosing a training provider"	Download the brochure
2	Day 2	Email	Case study: how a 90-person logistics firm trained its supervisors in 6 weeks	Read the case study
3	Day 5	Email	In-house vs public courses: costs, flexibility, results	See in-house options
4	Day 9	Email	FAQ: dates, venues in Ebène and in-company, certificates, languages	Ask us a question
5	Day 14	Email + sales task	Personal note from the account manager offering a 20-minute call	Book a call
6	Day 21	WhatsApp (if opted in)	Short reminder with the booking link	Book a call

Rules for good nurture content

- **One message, one job, one call to action.**
- **Mostly help, little sell:** roughly three useful messages for every direct offer.
- **Write as a person** (from a named advisor, not "noreply"), and invite replies.
- **Use the data you have:** course of interest, model of car, language, town.
- **Mix channels with care:** email for content, WhatsApp only for short, expected, opted-in messages.
- **Never let two flows collide:** a contact should be in one nurture flow at a time; use exits and suppression lists.

SECTION 12

Behaviour-based triggers

Time-based sequences send the same thing on day 2, day 5 and day 9. Behaviour-based triggers react to what the person actually does, which makes them far more relevant.

Behaviour (trigger)	Meaning	Automated response (example)
Visits the pricing page twice in 7 days	Comparing options, close to a decision	+10 points; email "Questions about prices?" from an advisor; task if MQL
Clicks a specific course or car model in an email	Interest in that product	Set "Product interest" property; switch to that product's nurture branch
Downloads a second resource	Research phase, growing interest	+10 points; recommend the next logical resource
Registers for a webinar or open day	High interest	Confirmation, reminders 1 day and 1 hour before; follow-up based on attended / missed
Starts a form or booking but does not finish	Hesitation or a problem	If you have their contact and consent: "Need help finishing your booking?" after 1 hour
Replies to an email or WhatsApp	Wants a conversation	Pause the automation; create a task; a human answers
No opens or clicks for 90 days	Lost interest	Re-engagement flow (Week 10); then suppress if no response
Deal marked "Lost – timing"	Not now, maybe later	Recycle to nurture; reminder task in 3–6 months

Behaviour (trigger)	Meaning	Automated response (example)
Purchase date + 11 months	Renewal or service due	Renewal or service reminder; offer for loyal customers

How tools see behaviour

- **Email clicks and opens:** recorded by Mailchimp, HubSpot and other email tools. Opens are unreliable since privacy features in mail apps, so base decisions on clicks.
- **Website visits:** HubSpot's tracking code links page views to known contacts after they submit a form. GA4 shows behaviour in aggregate but is not designed to identify individuals.
- **Messaging:** ManyChat records keywords, button clicks and answers as tags and custom fields.
- **Sales activity:** deal stages, calls and meetings logged in the CRM.

Tip: create a short "trigger library" for your business: 10 behaviours, what each means and the response. It becomes the brief for every workflow you build.

Behaviour tracking must be explained in your privacy notice and cookie banner. Do not send messages that feel like spying ("We saw you looked at the red SUV 4 times last night"). Use behaviour to choose the topic, not to comment on it.

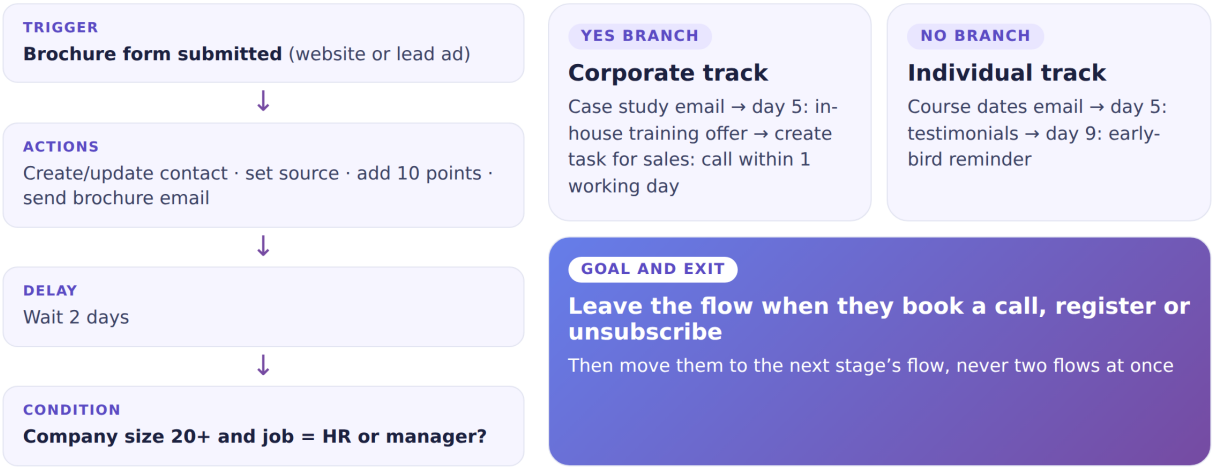
SECTION 13

Workflow design: triggers, branches, delays, goals

A workflow is a set of steps the system follows automatically. Designing it well on paper is the difference between a system that runs quietly for months and one that sends embarrassing messages.

Anatomy of a workflow: map it before you build it

Example: a brochure download for a training company



Step by step: design a workflow

1. **Name it clearly**: [Stage] – [Purpose] – [Version], e.g. "LEAD – Corporate brochure nurture – v2".
2. **Define enrolment**: the trigger and who is excluded (customers, competitors, people without marketing consent).

3. **Write the steps** in order: actions, delays (in business days where possible) and conditions.
4. **Add branches** only where the message really changes (profile, product, language, behaviour). Each branch must end somewhere.
5. **Set the goal and exits**: what success looks like and what removes people early.
6. **Decide re-enrolment**: can someone go through the flow twice (e.g. a second brochure next year)?
7. **Plan the handover**: which step creates a task or alert for a human?
8. **Document it** in your automation register (Section 26) with owner, tools, date and test results.

Branches, delays and timing

Element	Good practice	Common mistake
Conditions / branches	Branch on clean fields (dropdown values, tags); always add a "none of the above" path	Branching on free text that people type differently
Delays	Business days; send between 08:00 and 19:00 Mauritius time (GMT+4)	Messages at 03:00 because the tool uses another time zone
Wait until	"Wait until event or 5 days, whichever first"	Fixed waits that ignore a reply already received
Goals	Goal reached = exit and move to the next stage flow	No goal, so buyers keep getting sales emails
Suppression	Exclude people in active deals and recent buyers	Customers receiving lead nurture
Frequency cap	Max 2–3 marketing messages a week across all flows	Three flows sending on the same day

In Mauritius: set the time zone in every tool to Indian/Mauritius (GMT+4). Many tools default to the US or Europe, which shifts your "9:00 reminders" to the middle of the night. Also check public holidays (for example Cavadee, Divali, Eid, Christmas, Independence Day on 12 March) before scheduling sends.

SECTION 14

Zapier vs Make vs native integrations

Your tools need to talk to each other. There are three ways: a native integration built by the apps, Zapier, or Make. Choose the simplest one that is reliable.

Native integration, Zapier or Make?

Start with the simplest tool that does the job reliably

1 · NATIVE

Built-in connections

Apps connect directly: HubSpot ↔ Meta lead ads, Mailchimp ↔ Shopify, ManyChat ↔ Google Sheets.

Free or included; least to maintain

2 · ZAPIER

Simple and fast

Linear "Zaps": one trigger, then actions. Thousands of apps, easy for beginners.

Free: 100 tasks, two-step Zaps

3 · MAKE

Visual and flexible

"Scenarios" on a canvas with routers, filters and data tools. More power per rupee.

Free: 1,000 credits, 2 active scenarios

Plans and limits (checked October 2026)

	Zapier	Make
Name of an automation	Zap	Scenario
Billing unit	Tasks: each action step that runs successfully counts as one task	Credits: most module actions use 1 credit; some AI features use more (credits replaced "operations" on 27 August 2025)
Free plan	100 tasks a month; two-step Zaps (one trigger, one action); polling every 15 minutes; Tables and Forms included	Up to 1,000 credits a month; 2 active scenarios; scheduling every 15 minutes minimum; 5-minute maximum run time
First paid plan	Professional, from USD 19.99 a month (monthly billing): multi-step Zaps, premium apps	Core, USD 12 a month for 10,000 credits: unlimited active scenarios, 1-minute scheduling
Team plans	Team, from USD 69 a month, up to 25 users	Pro USD 21, Teams USD 38 a month (10,000 credits)
Style	Linear list of steps; very beginner-friendly	Visual canvas with routers, filters, iterators; more control
Best for	Quick, simple connections; non-technical teams	Multi-step, branching flows; better value at higher volume

Sources: zapier.com/pricing and help.zapier.com (Free plan, updated August 2026); make.com/en/pricing and the Make credits announcement. Annual billing is cheaper on both. Prices change often: check before you commit.

When to use what

Situation	Best option
HubSpot needs Facebook lead ads	Native: HubSpot ads tool (free)
ManyChat needs to save leads in a Google Sheet	Native ManyChat integration
New website form → add row to a sheet	Zapier free (two-step Zap)
Lead ad → CRM + sheet + alert + filter hot leads	Make (one scenario with a router) or Zapier paid (multi-step)
Hundreds of leads a day, several branches	Make (credits go further) or a paid CRM with built-in workflows
Data that must not fail (payments, contracts)	Native integration or a developer-built connection, with monitoring

Estimate your monthly usage: a quick calculation

Zapier: a two-step Zap uses 1 task per lead (the trigger is free, the action counts). 80 leads a month = 80 tasks, inside the free 100. A five-step Zap (4 actions) uses 4 tasks per lead: 80 leads = 320 tasks, which needs a paid plan.

Make: a scenario with 5 modules that all run uses about 5 credits per lead. 1,000 free credits ÷ 5 = about 200 leads a month, minus credits used by scheduled checks. Instant triggers (webhooks) and sensible schedules save credits.

> **Tip:** other options exist: n8n (open source, can be self-hosted), Pabbly Connect, and the built-in workflows of paid CRMs. The design skills in this guide work in all of them.

SECTION 15

Step by step: your first Zap in Zapier

Goal: every new Facebook or Instagram lead ad submission is added instantly to a Google Sheet that the sales team checks, instead of a weekly manual download. This fits in the free plan (one trigger, one action).

Before you start

- ☐ A live or test lead ad form in Meta (Week 8) and admin access to the Facebook Page
- ☐ A Google Sheet with column headers: Date, First name, Phone, Email, Interest, Timeframe, Source, Consent
- ☐ A free Zapier account (zapier.com) using a business email

Build it

1. In Zapier, click **Create → Zap**. Name it "LEAD – Meta lead ad to Sheet – v1".
2. **Trigger:** choose the app **Facebook Lead Ads**, event **New Lead**. Connect your Facebook account and choose the Page and the form.
3. **Test the trigger.** If no lead exists yet, submit a test lead with Meta's Lead Ads Testing Tool, then pull it into Zapier.
4. **Action:** choose **Google Sheets**, event **Create Spreadsheet Row**. Connect your Google account, select the spreadsheet and worksheet.
5. **Map the fields:** match each column to the lead data (first name, phone, email, answers). Type a fixed value "Meta lead ad" in Source.
6. **Test the action** and check that a correct row appears in the sheet.
7. **Publish** the Zap. Submit a final test lead and confirm it arrives within minutes.
8. **Monitor:** check **Zap history** weekly for errors, and turn on email notifications for errors.

Make it better on a paid plan

- Add a **Formatter** step to clean phone numbers into +230 format and names into proper case.
- Add **HubSpot: Create or Update Contact** so the lead is also in the CRM.
- Add a **Filter** ("Timeframe is Within 1 month") and a notification step (email or a team chat message) for hot leads only.
- Use **Paths** to send corporate and individual leads to different Mailchimp tags or HubSpot owners.

> Zapier stores and passes personal data. Use a business account, turn on two-factor authentication, share access only through Zapier's team features (not shared passwords) and include Zapier in your list of data processors (Section 25).

SECTION 16

Step by step: a multi-step scenario in Make

Goal: a website enquiry form sends each lead to the CRM, logs it in a sheet, emails the lead an instant reply and alerts sales only for hot leads. One scenario, five modules, built visually.

The scenario on one line

```
Webhook (form) → HubSpot: create/update contact → Google Sheets: add row → Router
   Route 1 (all leads):            Gmail: send instant reply to the lead
   Route 2 (filter: hot lead):     Gmail or Slack: alert the sales team
```

Build it

1. In Make, click **Create a new scenario**. Name it "LEAD – Website enquiry – v1".
2. Add the trigger module **Webhooks → Custom webhook**. Copy the webhook URL and paste it into your form tool's webhook setting (or use the form tool's own Make module if it has one: WordPress form plugins, Typeform, Google Forms and others do).
3. Submit a test entry so Make **learns the data structure**.
4. Add **HubSpot CRM → Create or update a contact** (search by email). Map first name, email, phone, interest, and set "Lead source = Website form".
5. Add **Google Sheets → Add a row** to keep a simple log the whole team can see.
6. Add a **Router**. On route 1, add **Gmail (or Email) → Send an email** to the lead with the brochure link. On route 2, click the link between the router and the module and set a **filter**: "Timeframe equals Within 1 month" OR "Request equals Quote".
7. On route 2, add an alert to sales (email, Slack or Microsoft Teams) with the lead's name, phone, interest and a link to the CRM record.
8. Click **Run once** and submit test entries for both a hot and a normal lead. Check every bubble: green means success, and you can inspect the data each module received and sent.
9. Set **error handling**: add an error handler on the HubSpot module (for example "Resume" or "Break" so failed runs can be retried) and turn on email notifications for errors.
10. Switch the scenario **ON**. With an instant webhook, it runs the moment a form arrives.

Useful Make vocabulary

Term	Meaning
Module	One step: an app action, search or tool
Router	Splits the flow into several routes (and uses no credits)
Filter	A condition on a route: only bundles that match continue
Bundle	One package of data (e.g. one lead) moving through the scenario
Iterator / aggregator	Split a list into items / combine items into one
Data store	A small table inside Make to remember values (e.g. last ID processed)
History / logs	Record of each run, with the data in every module, for troubleshooting

SECTION 17

Step by step: Instagram comment-to-DM with ManyChat

Goal: when someone comments "TRIAL" on a FitZone Reel, they receive a DM with the free-trial details, are asked for their WhatsApp number, are tagged, and are sent to a Google Sheet or CRM for follow-up. FitZone is the fictional gym in Quatre Bornes from Week 5.

Before you start

- ☐ An Instagram professional account connected to a Facebook Page (Week 5)
- ☐ In Instagram settings, allow access to messages for connected tools
- ☐ A ManyChat account connected to Instagram (free plan works for a test with up to 25 active contacts)

Build it

1. In ManyChat, go to **Automations → New automation** and choose the trigger **"User comments on your post or Reel"**. Select the Reel (or "any post") and the keyword **TRIAL** (add variants: "trial", "Trial", "ESSAI").
2. Turn on the **public reply** to the comment with 2–3 variations ("Sent you a DM!", "Check your messages") so it does not look robotic.
3. First DM: "Hi {first name}! Here is how the free trial class works: 45 minutes, any weekday, no commitment. Want us to book you in?" with buttons **Yes, book me** / **Tell me more**.
4. On **Yes**: ask "What's your WhatsApp number? We'll confirm your slot there." Use a **phone** input that saves to the system field, with consent wording: "By sending it you agree we contact you on WhatsApp about your trial."
5. Ask the preferred time with buttons (Morning / Lunchtime / Evening) and save it to a custom field.
6. Add actions: **Add tag** "trial-request", set custom field "Source = IG comment TRIAL".
7. Send the data on: ManyChat's Google Sheets integration, or Zapier/Make, or a CRM integration, so the front desk sees the request.
8. Final DM: "Thanks! Our coach Priya will confirm your slot on WhatsApp within 2 hours (07:00–21:00)." Then notify staff.
9. On **Tell me more**: send 3 short answers (prices, timetable, location) and the button again.
10. **Test** with a personal account (not the business one), check every branch, then set the automation **live** and mention the keyword in the Reel and caption.

Tip: the keyword must be easy to type and unique to the campaign (TRIAL, MENU, PRICE, GUIDE). Use a different keyword per campaign so you can see which Reel brought which leads.

In Mauritius: offer the conversation in the language people use in comments. A simple button "English / Français / Kreol" at the start lets the flow continue in the right language.

SECTION 18

WhatsApp automation and opt-in

WhatsApp is where most Mauritian sales conversations finish. Automating it well means knowing the difference between the free app and the Business Platform, respecting the messaging windows and collecting clear opt-in.

The free app or the Business Platform?

	WhatsApp Business app	WhatsApp Business Platform (API)
Access	Free app on a phone, plus linked devices	Through a provider (Business Solution Provider) or tools such as ManyChat (paid plans), HubSpot integrations, Brevo
Automation	Greeting and away messages, quick replies, labels, catalogue	Full automation: flows, chatbots, CRM integration, triggered templates, many agents
Outbound messages	Broadcast lists (only people who saved your number)	Approved message templates: marketing, utility, authentication
Cost	Free	Meta charges per delivered template message, by country; provider fees on top

Messaging windows and costs on the Platform (October 2026)

- **Per-message pricing** has applied since 1 July 2025: you pay for delivered template messages, at rates that depend on the category and the recipient’s country code.
- **Customer service window:** when a customer messages you, a 24-hour window opens in which you can reply with free-form (non-template) messages. Outside it, you must use an approved template.
- **Change from 1 October 2026:** Meta announced that service messages and utility messages sent within the customer service window are also charged per message (they were free before), at the same rates as utility messages in each market.
- **Free entry point:** when someone messages you from a Click-to-WhatsApp ad or a Facebook Page button, a 72-hour window opens in which messages are free.
- **The free app is not affected** by these Platform charges.

Opt-in: what Meta requires

Before you send messages on the Business Platform, you must have opt-in. Meta’s rules say you must clearly state that the person is opting in to receive messages from your business, clearly state your business name, and comply with the law. You can collect opt-in on your website, by SMS, by phone or in person. Under the Mauritius Data Protection Act 2017 you must also be able to prove consent (Section 25).

Where	Opt-in wording (example)
Website form	☐ Yes, I want to receive booking updates and occasional offers from FitZone Quatre Bornes on WhatsApp. I can stop at any time by replying STOP.
In a ManyChat DM	"Can we send your trial confirmation and class reminders on WhatsApp? [Yes, on WhatsApp] [No, email only]"
At the counter	Paper or tablet form with the same wording, date and signature; entered in the CRM the same day

Good WhatsApp automation habits

- Use WhatsApp for **expected, useful messages**: confirmations, reminders, documents requested, follow-ups the person agreed to.
- Keep marketing messages **rare and relevant**; people can block or report a business, which harms your number’s quality rating.
- Give a clear **opt-out** ("Reply STOP") and make sure the tool updates the contact’s consent automatically.
- **Hand over to a human** as soon as the person asks a real question; automation should never trap people in menus.

PART D

CRM, sales & quality

CRM integration, pipelines,
sales handoff, clean data
and testing your automations

SECTION 19

CRM integration: one source of truth

When leads live in five places (a sheet, Mailchimp, ManyChat, a phone and an inbox), nobody has the full picture. In an automation system, the CRM is the single source of truth: every tool sends data to it, and decisions are taken from it.

Design the data flow

1. **Choose the master system**: usually the CRM (for example HubSpot free). Other tools are "satellites".
2. **List every source** and how it reaches the CRM: native integration, Zapier, Make, import or manual entry.
3. **Choose the unique identifier** used for matching: email address first, phone number in E.164 format (+2305XXXXXXX) second.
4. **Map the fields**: which field in each tool goes to which CRM property (table below).
5. **Decide the direction**: one-way (form → CRM) or two-way (CRM ↔ email tool, for unsubscribes and tags). Unsubscribes must always flow back to every tool.
6. **Decide who can edit what**: for example, only sales changes deal stages; only automation changes the score.

Field mapping sheet (example)

CRM property	Website form	Meta lead ad	ManyChat	Notes
Email	email	email	Email (system field)	Main ID; lowercase
Phone	phone	phone_number	Phone (system field)	Format +230…
First name	first_name	first_name	First name	Proper case
Product interest	interest (dropdown)	custom question	Custom field	Same list of values everywhere
Lead source	hidden: utm_source	fixed: "Meta lead ad"	fixed: "IG comment"	Required on every lead
Marketing consent (email)	checkbox	custom disclaimer checkbox	button answer	With date and wording version
WhatsApp consent	checkbox	custom disclaimer checkbox	button answer	Separate from email
Preferred language	dropdown	custom question	button answer	EN / FR / Kreol

Common integration patterns

Pattern	Example	Watch out for
Capture → CRM	Lead ad → HubSpot contact	Duplicates when the same person uses a different email
CRM → email tool	HubSpot list "MQL – corporate" → Mailchimp tag	Consent must travel with the contact
CRM → sales alert	Lifecycle = MQL → WhatsApp or email alert to owner	Alert fatigue: alert only on real thresholds
Sales → marketing	Deal lost "timing" → back to nurture	Agree reasons and dates
Purchase → onboarding	Invoice paid in the accounting tool → onboarding flow	Do not send onboarding before payment is confirmed

SECTION 20

Pipelines, deal stages and tasks in HubSpot

Week 10 showed how to set up the HubSpot free CRM. This section turns it into the sales end of your automation system: a pipeline with clear stages, tasks that never let a deal go silent, and the automation you can (and cannot) run on free tools.

Design the pipeline

Business	Deal stages (with example win probability)
B2B training (SkillPort)	New MQL (10%) → Discovery call done (25%) → Proposal sent (50%) → Negotiation (70%) → Won (100%) / Lost (0%)
Car dealer (AutoVert)	New enquiry (10%) → Test drive booked (30%) → Test drive done (50%) → Offer and financing (70%) → Deposit paid / Won (100%) / Lost (0%)
Gym (FitZone)	Trial requested (20%) → Trial booked (40%) → Trial attended (60%) → Member / Won (100%) / Lost (0%)

Win probabilities are illustrative; set your own from past results and review them every quarter.

Step by step: set up the pipeline and tasks

1. Go to **Settings → Objects → Deals → Pipelines**. Rename the stages to match your process and set the probability for each.
2. Add **required properties** per stage where possible (for example "Amount" and "Expected close date" before "Proposal sent").
3. Create a deal for each SQL: **Deal name** "Company – product – month" (e.g. "Island Freight – Leadership – Nov"), amount in MUR, owner, close date, associated contact and company.
4. Add a **task** with a due date to every open deal: "Call to discuss proposal – Thursday 10:00". Use task queues so each salesperson starts the day with a list.
5. Use **email templates** and the **meetings link** so that prospects can book a call in your calendar.
6. Each Monday, review the **board view**: deals with no activity for 7 days, deals past their close date, deals without a next task.

What HubSpot free tools can and cannot automate

Need	Free tools	Paid option
Follow-up email after a form	Yes: one simple workflow per form, one action (send an email)	Starter: up to 10 actions per form workflow (Marketing Hub Starter)
Facebook lead ads into contacts	Yes: ads tool sync (all plans)	–
Multi-step workflows with branches	No	Marketing, Sales or Service Hub Professional or Enterprise
Automatic lead scoring	No: use a manual score property or a sheet	Marketing or Sales Hub Professional or Enterprise
Create tasks or assign owners automatically	No (CRM actions need paid users)	Paid seats; workflows on Professional
Fill the gaps	Zapier or Make can create contacts, deals and tasks through the HubSpot connection	–

Source: HubSpot Knowledge Base (form automations, workflows FAQ, lead scoring tool, Facebook lead ads), checked October 2026. Limits differ between accounts and change often: check Settings → Account & Billing → Usage & Limits.

Tip: a free CRM plus Make or Zapier can run a surprisingly complete system for a small business. Upgrade when the number of leads, users or workflows makes manual work or integration costs higher than the subscription.

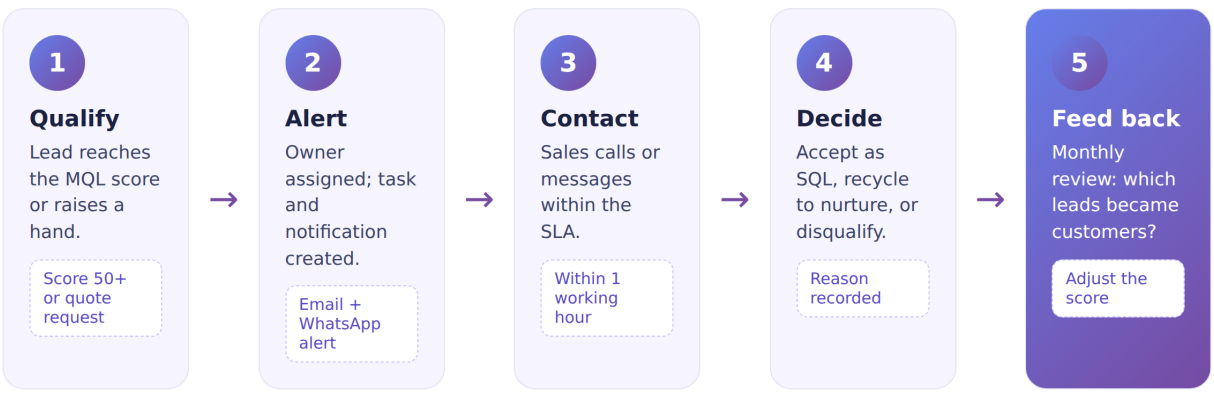
SECTION 21

Sales handoff and service-level agreements

The weakest point of most systems is the moment a lead passes from marketing to sales. A service-level agreement (SLA) is a simple written promise between the two teams: what marketing delivers, and how fast sales acts.

The marketing-to-sales handoff

An agreed service-level agreement (SLA) stops good leads from going cold



What a marketing–sales SLA contains

Element	Example (illustrative)
MQL definition	Score 50+ (fit and engagement), or any hand-raiser action
Information passed to sales	Name, company, phone, source, interest, score, last 3 actions, consent status
Speed to first contact	Hand-raisers within 1 working hour; MQLs within 1 working day
Number of attempts	3 attempts over 5 working days (call, WhatsApp, email) before recycling
Outcome required	Within 5 working days: Accept (SQL), Recycle (back to nurture with reason) or Disqualify (with reason)
Marketing promise	At least 30 MQLs a month, with complete data
Review	Monthly meeting: MQL → SQL rate, reasons for recycling, score changes

Automating the handoff

1. **Trigger:** score reaches 50, or a hand-raiser form is submitted.
2. **Update** the lifecycle stage to MQL and record the date.
3. **Assign an owner** (by product, region or rotation).
4. **Create a task** due within the SLA and send an alert with a link to the record.
5. **Stop marketing nurture** for this contact, so sales and marketing do not both write.
6. **Escalate:** if the task is still open after the SLA, alert the sales manager.
7. **Recycle:** if sales chooses "Recycle", the contact goes back to a slower nurture flow with a reminder date.

> **In Mauritius:** in a small market, a lead often contacts two or three competitors the same day. The business that replies first with a helpful, personal answer usually gets the visit. Measure your own speed to first contact and make it a weekly team number.

SECTION 22

Data hygiene and deduplication

Automation multiplies whatever is in your database. Clean data gives relevant messages and reliable reports; dirty data sends "Dear FIRSTNAME" emails to the same person three times.

The most common data problems

Problem	Example	Fix
Duplicates	Same person from a lead ad, a form and WhatsApp	Match on email, then phone; merge in the CRM
Inconsistent phone formats	57XXXXXX, 230 57XX XXXX, +230-57XXXXXX	Normalise to +2305XXXXXXX on entry
Inconsistent values	"Excel", "excel course", "MS Excel"	Dropdowns instead of free text; one list of values
Missing source	Leads with "Unknown" source	Required hidden fields and fixed values per integration
Fake or test data	test@test.com, asdf	Spam protection; delete or tag test contacts
Outdated consent	Unsubscribed in Mailchimp but still "subscribed" in the CRM	Two-way sync of unsubscribes; monthly check
Bounced and inactive	Hard bounces, no activity for 12 months	Suppress or archive; keep the consent record

Deduplication: step by step

1. **Prevent first:** integrations should use "create or update" (search by email or phone) instead of "create".
2. **Normalise on entry:** lowercase emails, trim spaces, phone in +230 format, proper-case names (Zapier Formatter, Make text functions, Google Sheets formulas).
3. **Find duplicates:** HubSpot suggests duplicate contacts and companies for review; in a sheet, sort by email and phone or use COUNTIF.
4. **Merge carefully:** keep the most recent data and the full history; never lose consent records.
5. **Schedule a monthly clean-up:** 30 minutes on the first Monday of the month.

Data rules for the whole team

☐ Every lead has a source, an owner and a consent status

☐ Product interest and lifecycle stage use fixed lists, never free text

☐ Phone numbers always in international format

☐ No personal data in task titles or deal names beyond the name

☐ Test contacts use a clear pattern (test+name@yourdomain.mu) and are deleted after testing

☐ Unsubscribes and objections are applied in every tool within 48 hours

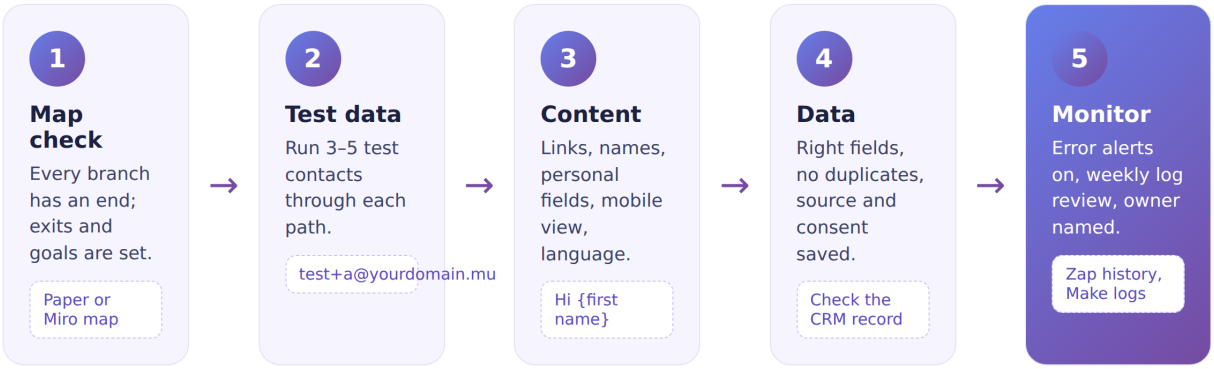
SECTION 23

Testing and quality assurance (QA)

An untested automation is a public mistake waiting to happen. Testing takes an hour; fixing a wrong message sent to 500 people takes much longer, and some mistakes cannot be undone.

Test every automation before it meets a real customer

Five checks that catch most problems



Pre-launch QA checklist

- ☐ Trigger fires once per real event (not twice, not on test submissions only)
- ☐ Each branch tested with a contact that should go down it, including the "none of the above" path
- ☐ Personal fields have a fallback ("Hi there" if no first name)
- ☐ All links work, have UTM tags and open correctly on a phone
- ☐ Language branches send the right language
- ☐ Delays and send times are correct in Mauritius time
- ☐ Goals and exits work: a test contact who books a call leaves the flow
- ☐ Suppression works: customers and unsubscribed contacts are excluded
- ☐ Data lands in the right CRM fields; no duplicates created
- ☐ Consent and source are saved
- ☐ Sales alerts reach the right person, with the right details
- ☐ Error notifications are on and go to an inbox someone reads

Monitoring after launch

When	What to check	Where
First 48 hours	Every run, every message, every new contact	Zap history, Make scenario history, HubSpot or Mailchimp activity
Weekly	Errors, stopped Zaps or scenarios, unusual volumes (0 leads or 10 times more)	Tool dashboards, error emails
Monthly	Conversion by step, unsubscribes, complaints, content still correct (prices, dates)	Reports (Section 24)
When anything changes	New form fields, new prices, new staff, new tools	Re-test the affected flows

When something breaks

1. **Pause** the automation (turn off the Zap, scenario or workflow).
2. **Find the cause** in the history or logs: which step failed, with which data?
3. **Fix and re-test** with test contacts.
4. **Replay or fix affected records**: Zapier and Make let you re-run failed runs; otherwise update records by hand.
5. **Apologise if customers were affected**, simply and honestly, and note the lesson in the automation register.

PART E

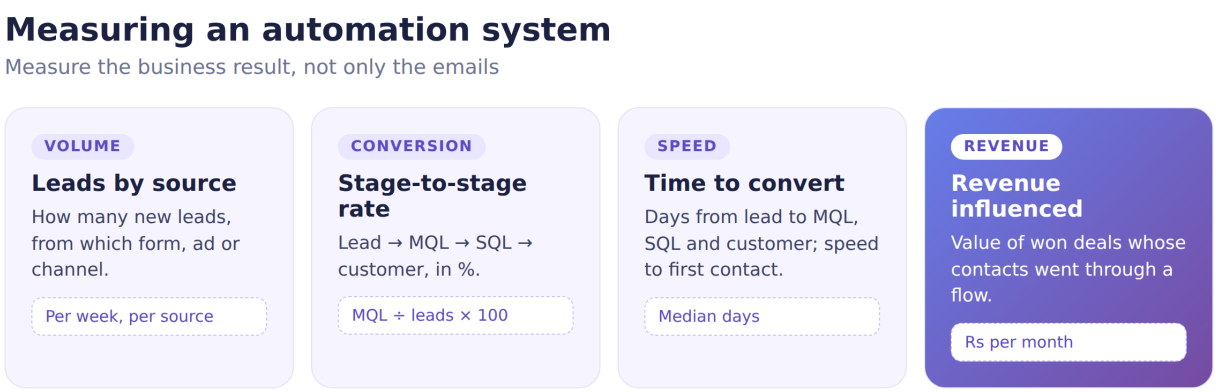
Measure & govern

Conversion by stage, time to convert, revenue influenced, compliance and maintenance

SECTION 24

Measuring your automation system

Open and click rates tell you whether emails work. To know whether the system works, measure how many leads move through each stage, how fast, and how much revenue they bring.



Key formulas

Metric	Formula	What it tells you
Lead-to-MQL rate	MQLs ÷ new leads × 100	Quality of leads and nurture
MQL-to-SQL rate	SQLs ÷ MQLs × 100	Whether sales agrees with your scoring
SQL-to-customer (win) rate	Deals won ÷ SQLs × 100	Sales effectiveness and offer
Lead-to-customer rate	New customers ÷ new leads × 100	Overall system efficiency
Time to convert	Date became customer − date became lead (median, in days)	Speed of the sales cycle
Speed to first contact	Time of first sales contact − time lead arrived	SLA respected or not
Cost per lead / per customer	Marketing cost ÷ leads, ÷ customers	Efficiency of each channel
Revenue influenced	Value of won deals whose contacts were in at least one flow	Contribution of automation
Pipeline value	Sum of open deal amounts (× stage probability for a forecast)	Future revenue

Worked example (illustrative)

In one month, SkillPort Training receives 200 new leads. 40 become MQLs, 18 become SQLs and 6 deals are won, worth Rs 540,000 in total. Marketing spend (ads and tools) is Rs 60,000.

Metric	Calculation	Result
Lead-to-MQL	40 ÷ 200 × 100	20%
MQL-to-SQL	18 ÷ 40 × 100	45%
SQL-to-customer	6 ÷ 18 × 100	33%

Metric	Calculation	Result
Lead-to-customer	6 ÷ 200 × 100	3%
Cost per lead	Rs 60,000 ÷ 200	Rs 300
Cost per customer	Rs 60,000 ÷ 6	Rs 10,000
Average deal value	Rs 540,000 ÷ 6	Rs 90,000
Return on marketing spend	Rs 540,000 ÷ Rs 60,000	9 to 1

Reading the funnel: where is the leak?

Symptom	Likely cause	What to try
Many leads, few MQLs	Wrong audience or weak lead magnet; nurture not relevant	Tighten targeting; add qualifying questions; improve nurture content
Many MQLs, few SQLs	Score too generous; sales not calling fast enough	Raise threshold; check speed to first contact
Many SQLs, few wins	Offer, price or sales process	Review lost reasons; proposal follow-up flow
Long time to convert	Too few touchpoints; slow follow-up	Add behaviour triggers and reminder tasks

Where to get the numbers

- **CRM reports:** contacts by lifecycle stage and source, deals created and won, pipeline value, time in stage (HubSpot dashboards).
- **Email and ManyChat reports:** clicks and conversions per message; which step loses people.
- **GA4:** sessions and key events (form submissions, bookings) by source, with UTM-tagged links in every message (Week 2).
- **A monthly dashboard** in Data Studio or a Google Sheet combining CRM exports and GA4 (Week 18 covers reporting).

> **Tip:** "revenue influenced" overstates impact if almost every contact is in a flow. Compare with a simple control: for one month, leave a small random group of new leads out of one nurture flow and compare their conversion rate with the rest.

SECTION 25

Compliance: consent, unsubscribes and the law

Automation sends more messages, faster, to more people, so mistakes about consent are multiplied too. In Mauritius the Data Protection Act 2017 (DPA 2017) applies; when you target people in the European Union, the GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) can apply as well. This is practical guidance, not legal advice.

What the DPA 2017 means for automation

Rule (DPA 2017)	What it means for your system
Section 23: when collecting data, tell people the purpose, who receives it, and their rights (including withdrawing consent and complaining to the Commissioner)	Every form, lead ad and chatbot links to a privacy notice that lists your tools (CRM, email tool, Zapier/Make, ManyChat) as recipients or processors.
Section 24: the controller bears the burden of proving consent; consent can be withdrawn at any time	Store date, source, wording and channel of consent on each contact. Unsubscribe or STOP must work in every message and update every tool.
Section 40: people can object to processing for direct marketing, and must be told about this right	An objection removes the contact from all marketing flows, permanently, across tools.
Section 38: right not to be subject to a decision based solely on automated processing (with exceptions such as explicit consent or a contract)	Use lead scores to prioritise follow-up, not to automatically refuse a service, a loan or an application. Keep a human in the loop for decisions that matter.

Source: Data Protection Act 2017 (Mauritius), sections 23, 24, 38 and 40. Week 10 covers registration, breach notification and penalties.

Consent rules for an automation system

1. **Separate consents per channel:** email marketing, WhatsApp marketing and SMS are different checkboxes or buttons.
2. **Transactional vs marketing:** a booking confirmation or a requested brochure is a service message; the nurture sequence that follows is marketing and needs consent.
3. **Consent travels with the contact:** every integration must pass the consent fields; never "assume yes".
4. **Unsubscribes sync everywhere** within 48 hours at most; ideally instantly through the integration.
5. **Keep only what you need** and delete or anonymise leads that never engaged after a defined period (for example 24 months), unless you have a reason to keep them.
6. **Know your processors:** Zapier, Make, HubSpot, Mailchimp and ManyChat store data outside Mauritius. Read their data processing terms and mention them in your privacy notice.
7. **Secure every account:** two-factor authentication, individual logins, access removed when someone leaves.

> Never import a list of phone numbers collected for another purpose (customers' delivery numbers, a business card bowl, a bought database) into a WhatsApp or email marketing flow. It breaks the DPA 2017 and Meta's opt-in rules, and it can get your WhatsApp number restricted.

SECTION 26

Governance: documentation, ownership and maintenance

An automation system is like a car: it needs an owner, a logbook and regular servicing. Without them, flows keep running long after the offer, the price or the person in charge has changed.

The automation register

Keep one sheet listing every automation. It takes 2 minutes per automation and saves hours when something goes wrong or a team member leaves.

Column	Example
Name and version	LEAD – Corporate brochure nurture – v2
Purpose and goal	Move corporate leads to a discovery call; goal = meeting booked
Trigger and audience	Corporate brochure form; excludes customers and no-consent contacts
Tools and connections	HubSpot form → Make → Mailchimp tag; alert by email
Owner and backup	Marketing lead / sales manager
Data used	Name, email, company size, job, consent
Last tested / last reviewed	12 Oct 2026 / monthly
KPIs	Lead → MQL rate, meetings booked, unsubscribes
Status	Live / paused / retired

Maintenance rhythm

When	Task
Weekly	Check errors and volumes; clear sales tasks older than the SLA
Monthly	Review KPIs per flow; update content with old dates or prices; data clean-up; MQL review with sales
Quarterly	Review scoring model and thresholds; retire flows that no longer help; check tool costs and usage
Yearly	Full audit: consent records, privacy notice, access rights, all flows re-tested

Using AI inside your system (link to Week 14)

Week 14 showed how AI steps can classify enquiries, summarise conversations or draft replies inside Zapier, Make or ManyChat. In a lead system, AI is most useful for **sorting and summarising** (for example "classify this enquiry as corporate, individual or support" or "summarise the last 5 messages for the salesperson"). Keep a human in charge of anything sent to customers, and remember that AI steps can use more credits or tasks than ordinary steps.

> **Cost control:** list every tool in the register with its plan, monthly cost in rupees and usage (tasks, credits, contacts). Review it quarterly; small subscriptions add up, and unused paid plans are common.

PART F

Put it to work

Three example systems, a case study, your Automation System, templates and checklists

SECTION 27

Case study and System 1: a B2B training company

"SkillPort Training" is a fictional but realistic training company in Ebène with four staff. It sold corporate courses mainly through the founder’s network. Leads from LinkedIn, Facebook lead ads and its website were handled in an inbox and a notebook, and many were never followed up.

1. The starting point (audit)

- About 120 leads a month from 4 sources, saved in 3 places (inbox, Excel, Meta downloads every Friday).
- Brochures sent manually, on average 2 days after the request.
- No definition of a "good lead"; the founder called whoever she remembered.
- No follow-up after proposals; no record of why deals were lost.

2. The system they built (step by step)

#	Step	Tool	Platforms connected
1	Lead arrives (website form, Facebook lead ad, LinkedIn form)	HubSpot form; HubSpot ads sync; Make for LinkedIn leads	Website, Meta, LinkedIn → HubSpot
2	Contact created or updated with source, interest, company size, consent	HubSpot free CRM	HubSpot
3	Brochure sent instantly	HubSpot form follow-up email	HubSpot → email
4	Lead logged and scored (fit + engagement) in a sheet; score copied to CRM	Make + Google Sheets formulas	HubSpot ↔ Sheets
5	Tag sent to Mailchimp: corporate or individual nurture	Make → Mailchimp tag; Mailchimp flow (Essentials)	HubSpot → Mailchimp
6	Score 50+ or hand-raiser: stage = MQL, alert by email to the account manager, deal created	Make → HubSpot deal; email alert	Sheets → HubSpot → email
7	Proposal sent: follow-up reminder on day 3, case study email on day 5	HubSpot tasks and templates	HubSpot
8	Deal won: joining instructions and WhatsApp reminder the day before	Mailchimp tag + WhatsApp Business app	HubSpot → Mailchimp, WhatsApp

3. Results after 4 months (illustrative)

KPI	Before	After 4 months
Time to send the brochure	2 days	Under 1 minute
Speed to first sales contact (MQLs)	Often never	Median 3 working hours
Lead-to-MQL rate	Not measured	22%
MQL-to-SQL rate	Not measured	48%
Corporate deals won per month	2	5
Median time from lead to customer	About 60 days	About 38 days
Tool costs per month	Rs 0	About Rs 3,000 (Mailchimp and Make paid plans; illustrative)

What made the difference: instant brochures, one CRM, a simple score that sales trusted and, above all, a rule that every MQL gets a call within one working day. The founder now spends her time on calls with the best leads instead of searching her inbox.

> **The lesson:** the biggest gains did not come from clever branches but from speed, one source of truth and a clear handoff rule.

SECTION 28

Systems 2 and 3: a car dealer and a gym

Two more systems you can copy and adapt. Both connect at least four platforms and fit the budget of a small Mauritian business.

System 2: AutoVert Motors, test-drive machine (Phoenix)

Goal: turn Facebook lead ads and Click-to-WhatsApp enquiries into booked and attended test drives.

1. **Capture:** Facebook lead ad "Book a test drive" with questions: model, timeframe, trade-in (yes/no), preferred contact. Click-to-WhatsApp ads go to the sales WhatsApp Business number.
2. **Sync:** lead ads sync to HubSpot (ads tool). WhatsApp enquiries are logged in HubSpot by the salesperson with a mobile form (Google Form → Zapier → HubSpot) at the end of each conversation.
3. **Score and route (Make):** timeframe "within 1 month" or test drive requested = hot. Hot leads create a HubSpot deal "New enquiry" and an alert to the duty salesperson; others get a "model brochure + financing guide" email.
4. **Book:** the salesperson sends a meetings link; when the test drive is booked, the deal moves to "Test drive booked".
5. **Remind:** WhatsApp reminder the day before (customer opted in) and an email with the showroom map.
6. **Follow up:** after the test drive, a task for a call within 24 hours and an email with a personalised offer and financing options.
7. **Nurture the "not now":** deals lost for timing go to a monthly "new arrivals and offers" email, and a 3-month reminder task.
8. **Customer stage:** after delivery, a thank-you message, a review request after 14 days, and service reminders at 11 months.

Platform	Role
Meta lead ads / Click-to-WhatsApp	Capture
HubSpot free CRM	Contacts, deals, tasks, meetings link
Make	Scoring rules, routing, alerts
Mailchimp	Brochures, nurture and service reminder emails
WhatsApp Business app	Conversations and reminders

System 3: FitZone, Instagram to membership (Quatre Bornes)

Goal: turn Reel viewers into trial-class bookings and members, with almost no manual admin.

1. **Capture:** Reels with "Comment TRIAL"; ManyChat comment-to-DM collects WhatsApp number, preferred time and consent (Section 17).
2. **Log:** ManyChat sends each request to a Google Sheet "Trial requests" (native integration).
3. **Alert and book:** Zapier (two-step Zap, free plan) emails the front desk for every new row; staff confirm the slot on WhatsApp within 2 hours.
4. **Remind:** the front desk sets a WhatsApp reminder the evening before; ManyChat sends an Instagram DM reminder if the person is still within the 24-hour window.
5. **After the trial:** the coach marks "attended" in the sheet; a Mailchimp tag starts a 3-email "Your first month" offer sequence for those who gave email consent.
6. **Member onboarding:** welcome message, class guide, a check-in at week 2 and a referral offer at week 6.
7. **Win-back:** members who have not checked in for 30 days get a friendly "We miss you" message from their coach.

> **Tip:** System 3 can start for almost nothing: ManyChat free (25 active contacts) to test, Google Sheets, Zapier free and Mailchimp free (up to 250 contacts and 500 sends a month). Upgrade the part that hits its limit first, usually ManyChat contacts.

SECTION 29

Exercises and your Automation System

Your Week 15 deliverable is an **Automation System**: a complete automation workflow with at least 5 steps connecting multiple platforms, documented and tested. Work on a real business: your own, your employer’s or one you know well.

Exercise A · Journey map and lifecycle (45 min)

Using Sections 2 and 5, define the lifecycle stages and entry rules for the business, and map one journey: entry points, stages, questions, what happens today and the gaps. Mark the 5 best automation opportunities with the impact and effort test (Section 6).

Exercise B · Lead scoring model (45 min)

Following Section 10, build a scoring model with 6–12 fit and engagement rules, negative points, decay, an MQL threshold and hand-raisers. Score 10 real or realistic leads in a Google Sheet with a SUM formula and explain whether the results match your instinct.

Exercise C · Build and test one connection (60 min)

Create a free Zapier, Make or ManyChat account and build one working automation (for example lead form → Google Sheet + email alert). Test it with 3 test contacts and take screenshots of the editor and the run history.

Deliverable: your Automation System

Part	Content
1. Business and goal	The offer, the audience and the measurable goal of the system
2. Lifecycle and journey	Stage definitions and the journey map with gaps
3. Workflow map	A diagram of the full workflow: trigger, at least 5 steps, conditions, delays, goal and exits
4. Platforms and integrations	At least 3 platforms (e.g. ManyChat, Google Sheets, HubSpot, Mailchimp, WhatsApp) and how they connect (native, Zapier or Make)
5. Lead scoring and handoff	Your scoring model, MQL threshold and a one-page sales SLA
6. Messages	The nurture or follow-up messages with timing and full copy of the first 2
7. Build evidence	Screenshots of the live build (at least the core steps), test results and the QA checklist
8. Measurement and compliance	KPIs and formulas, consent wording, unsubscribe handling, automation register entry

Submit a link to your Automation System (Google Doc or PDF, 6–10 pages, with your workflow diagram and screenshots) on the learning platform, Module 15 exercises.

TEMPLATES

Copy-and-use templates

Workflow design sheet

Field	Your answer
Workflow name and version	
Goal (what success looks like)	
Trigger	
Who is excluded	
Steps (action, delay, condition)	
Branches and their conditions	
Exit criteria	
Human handover (who, when)	
Tools and connections	
Data fields used	
Consent required	
KPIs	
Owner and review date	

Lead scoring sheet

Type	Rule	Points	Data source
Fit			
Fit			
Fit			
Engagement			
Engagement			
Engagement			
Negative / decay			
Hand-raiser		Straight to sales	
MQL threshold			

Sales SLA (one page)

Item	Agreement
MQL definition	
Speed to first contact	
Attempts before recycling	
Outcomes and reasons	
Monthly MQL target	
Review meeting	

SECTION 30

Checklists, mistakes to avoid and glossary

Automation system launch checklist

- ☐ Lifecycle stages and entry rules written and agreed with sales
- ☐ Journey mapped; first 5 automations chosen
- ☐ All lead sources feed one CRM with source and consent
- ☐ Unique ID and field mapping defined; phone numbers normalised
- ☐ Scoring model with threshold, hand-raisers and decay
- ☐ Nurture flows per stage with goals, exits and suppression
- ☐ Sales SLA, alerts and tasks in place
- ☐ WhatsApp opt-in wording and STOP handling
- ☐ Every flow tested; error alerts on
- ☐ Automation register and monthly KPI review in the diary

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Automating a messy process	Map and fix the process first
Leads in many places	One CRM as the source of truth
"Create" instead of "create or update"	Match on email or phone to avoid duplicates
No goals or exits	Every flow ends when the goal is reached
Scores nobody trusts	Simple model built and reviewed with sales
Slow handoff	SLA with alerts, tasks and escalation
WhatsApp blasts without opt-in	Clear opt-in, rare and useful messages, easy STOP
Launching without testing	Test contacts through every branch
Set and forget	Owner, register and monthly review

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Marketing automation	Software that captures, organises and follows up leads automatically, based on rules
Lead lifecycle	The stages from subscriber to lead, MQL, SQL, opportunity, customer and advocate
MQL	Marketing Qualified Lead: good fit and enough interest for sales to contact
SQL	Sales Qualified Lead: sales confirmed a real need, budget and timing
Lead scoring	Points for fit and engagement to decide who sales contacts first
Fit / engagement score	Points for who the lead is / for what the lead does
Decay	Engagement points losing value as time passes
Hand-raiser	A lead who directly asks for a quote, call or test drive
Lead nurturing	Useful, relevant messages that build the relationship until a lead is ready
Trigger / action	The event that starts an automation / a step the system performs
Branch, router, path	A split in a workflow based on a condition
Goal / exit criteria	The outcome that ends a flow / rules that remove people early
Zap / task (Zapier)	An automation / one successful action step, the billing unit
Scenario / module / credit (Make)	An automation / one step / the billing unit (formerly operations)
Webhook	An instant message from one app to another when something happens
Native integration	A connection built directly between two apps
SLA	Service-level agreement: what marketing delivers and how fast sales acts
Speed to first contact	Time between a lead arriving and the first sales contact
Deduplication	Finding and merging duplicate records
Customer service window	WhatsApp’s 24-hour period after a customer message for free-form replies
Message template	A pre-approved WhatsApp message required outside the service window
Revenue influenced	Value of won deals whose contacts went through at least one automation